LGBTQ+ People and Victimization

Recent studies report that LGBTQ+ adults and youth disproportionately face hardships that are risk factors for victimization and violence. We also know that Transgender people and LGBTQ+ people of color are even more vulnerable.

Some of these factors include higher rates of poverty, overrepresentation in the youth homeless population and the foster care system, and a fear of reporting. Exposure to violence can cause longstanding psychological and emotional stress that can display in many different ways. A person experiencing victimization may exhibit depression, anxiety, anti-social behavior, and even Post Traumatic Stress Disorder.

Support and counseling is often beneficial to help overcome these overwhelming feelings. There are resources available to you that may help you feel safer and regain a sense of control in your life.

LGBTQ+ Youth

LGBTQ+ youth and those perceived as LGBTQ+ are at an increased risk of being bullied. Social media such as Facebook, Twitter, Tumblr, and others have created new platforms for cyberbullying which can be just as traumatic. Bullying puts youth at increased risk for depression, suicidal thoughts, misuse of drugs and alcohol, risky sexual behavior, and it can affect academics as well. For LGBTQ youth this risk is even higher. If you are experiencing bullying, or negative thoughts about yourself please reach out to a trusted adult or to one of the listed resources provided.

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LGBTQ+ Victims of Crime

OFFICE OF VICTIMS ADVOCACY
(502) 696-5312



1024 Capital Center Drive, Suite 200
Frankfort, Kentucky 40601

VICTIM INFORMATION LINE
(800) 372-2551

ag.ky.gov/victims

Violence Against Women Reauthorization Act (2013)

This act was signed on March 7, 2013 and amends the Violence Against Women Act (VAWA) of 1994 by adding a grant condition that prohibits discrimination by all programs funded by VAWA.

> "No person in the United States shall, on the basis of actual or perceived race, color, religion, national origin, sex, gender identity (as defined in paragraph 249(c)(4) of title 18, United States Code), sexual orientation, or disability, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any program or activity funded in whole or in part with funds made available under [VAWA], and any other program or activity funded in whole or in part with funds appropriated for grants, cooperative agreements, and other assistance administered by the Office on Violence Against Women."

The Kentucky VAWA Implementation Plan places priorities on increasing accessibility for federal and state funded victim services for all individuals throughout the commonwealth, reducing domestic violence related homicides, and ensuring the needs of underserved populations, including LGBTQ+, in our state are being met.

OFFICE OF THE ATTORNEY GENERAL

Office of Victims Advocacy
1024 Capital Center Drive, Suite 200
Frankfort, Kentucky 40601

ag.ky.gov/victims

OVA Information

The Office of Victims Advocacy within the Office of the Attorney General has victim advocates on staff who can answer general questions about a wide range of topics such as the criminal justice process and crime victim rights and can provide referrals to victim resources and services in the caller's local area. Our advocates also provide notification of court proceedings, accompaniment to court proceedings and attorney interviews, assistance filing for victim compensation and restitution, referrals to community resources, guidance with victim impact statements, etc. in cases prosecuted by the Office of the Attorney General. Our crime victim information line is (502) 696-5312. Here is a link to our Crime Victim Information Guide: https://ag.ky.gov/publications/AG%20Publications/Crime-Victims-Information-Guide.pdf

Community Mental Health Centers

Kentucky's Community Mental Health Centers (CMHC) provide a comprehensive range of accessible, coordinated, direct or indirect mental health services through 14 regional MH/IDD boards. Regional boards are private, nonprofit organizations serving residents of designated multicounty regions. Services include inpatient services, outpatient services, therapeutic rehabilitation services, and emergency services. For additional information see https://chfs.ky.gov/agencies/dms/dpo/bpb/Pages/cmhc.aspx or call (502) 564-6890. If you are online and wish to locate a provider in your area click here. The Association for Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender Issues in Counseling group has a directory of LGBTQ+ friendly mental health specialists across the United States. Specialists listed are verified members of AGLBTIC, a division of the American Counseling Association.

Resources for Information and Assistance

The Network/ La Red
Provides emotional support, information, and safety planning for LGBTQ+ communities who are being abused or have been abused by a partner. Support available in English and Spanish.
(617) 742-1141
https://tnlr.org/en/

National Coalition of Anti-Violence Programs
A coalition of programs that document and advocate for victims of anti-LGBT and anti-HIV/AIDS violence/harassment, domestic violence, sexual assault, and police misconduct.
(212) 714-1141
https://avp.org/ncavp/

FORGE (for Transgender and Non-Conforming Survivors)
Provides services for transgender persons experiencing violence.
https://forge-forward.org/about/contact-us/

GLBT National Help Center
Provides peer support for LGBTQ+ people.
(800) 246-PRIDE/7743
https://www.volunteerlogin.org/chat

The Trevor Project
The world's largest suicide prevention and crisis intervention organization for LGBTQ young people; a non-profit that provides 24/7 life-saving support via phone, text, and chat.
(866) 488-7386

GLBT National Hotline
Call center that refers to over 15,500 resources across the country to support LGBTQ+ people.
(888) 843-4564